

reflecting the high level of immigration into the Northern states starting in the 1840s. The largest contingent were Germans, of whom some 200,000 served the Union during the war. The second-largest immigrant group in the ranks were the Irish, with around 150,000 men engaged. Both Germans and Irish often served in their own regiments—the 69th New York Infantry Regiment (dubbed “the Fighting 69th”) was Irish, the 74th Pennsylvania Regiment was German. But members of these and other immigrant groups also served in regiments that were not ethnically defined. The same was not true of Black Americans who became an important component of Union fighting forces from 1863—Black troops made up 10 percent of the Union army by the war’s end—but who fought in segregated units.



Union officer's kepi

The blue kepi-style cap with black visor was standard wear for Union soldiers. The horn insignia on the front was that of the infantry.